

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

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1. COUNTRY: CHILE
2. SUBJECT: Unidentified Flying Objects
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12. ORIGINATOR: U.S. Air Attache, Santiago, Chile
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5. SUMMARY:

Unidentified flying objects continue to be reported at irregular intervals. This report contains an eye witness account by one of the Chilean National Airlines pilots.

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Sensational declarations made by pilot Marcelo Cisternas, Chief of LAN flight operations. Strange experience lived by the five crew members of the DC-6B over the skies of Arica.

"It was something mechanical--zigzagging--its movements were not precise--suddenly it changed direction and came directly toward us--it gave me the impression that it had located us with radar..."

"These are the declarations made by Marcelo Cisternas, LAN pilot, who together with all the crew members saw a strange flying object in Arica on Monday, 6 September."

5. DISTRIBUTION BY ORIGINATOR:

USCINCSO

17. DOWNGRADING DATA:

18. ATTACHMENT DATA:

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DD FORM 1396

REPLACES DA FORM 1049, 1 AUG 60,
ORNAV FORM 3820 (Rev. 10-61),
AF FORM 112, JUL 51, WHICH MAY BE
USED UNTIL 1 JAN 62.

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CONTINUATION SHEET

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ORIGINATOR U.S. Air Attache
Santiago, Chile

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"During 13 to 14 minutes this strange object followed us. It gave me the impression that when it located us it tried to identify us. At once we requested information from the Flight Control Tower in Arica and Iquique. We were informed that no other flights had been scheduled in that zone. Then I told them what we were watching."

"The pilot of the DC-6B LAN Flight #904 is Chief of Flight Operations. He has been a LAN pilot for eleven years."

"I have never had a similar experience. I didn't believe in "them". It was not an optical vision due to atmospherical reflections. I am sure it was a mechanical apparatus. The plane was flying at an altitude of 8,500 feet, at a speed of 500 Kms. The night was cloudy and without stars. I was not the only one who saw this strange object, the co-pilot, the engineer, hostess and steward also saw it. It emitted a light of an intense color, then changed and turned to radiant white. It was suspended at a distance of about 3 Kms. from us, in a straight line--it was more or less 2130 hours. Suddenly the same way it appeared it withdrew at an incredible speed, without leaving any track."

"Pilot Marcelo Cisternas was interviewed by La Nación when he arrived, and then called urgently to the LAN Vice President's Office."

Comments: Many sightings have been reported in the northern area of Chile. Personal conversation with the Chilean Air Force Wing Commander at Antofagasta reveals that none of the Chilean Air Force personnel in that area have been fortunate enough to catch sight of one.

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